

HYACINTHUS

Hyacinth

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of bulbs, grown for their dense spikes of fragrant, tubular flowers; is ideal for spring bedding displays and for pot cultivation indoors. Vulnerable to frost damage in containers. Needs an open, sunny situation or partial shade and well-drained soil. Plant in fall. For winter flowers, force large-sized, specially “treated” bulbs of *H. orientalis* cultivars by potting in early fall. Keep cool and damp for several weeks to ensure adequate root systems develop. When shoot tips are visible, move into max. 50°F (10°C) at first, raising the temperature as the shoot grows and giving as much light as possible. After forcing, keep in a cool place to finish growth, then plant outdoors to recover. Propagate by offsets in late summer. ☉ All parts may cause stomach upset if ingested; contact with bulbs may aggravate skin allergies.

H. amethystinus. See *Brimeura amethystina*.

H. azureus. See *Muscari azureum*.

H. orientalis ‘Amsterdam’. Winter- or spring-flowering bulb. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 3in (8cm). Has strap-shaped, channeled, semierect, glossy, basal leaves that develop fully only after flowering. Flower stem bears a dense, cylindrical spike of fragrant, tubular, bright rose-red flowers, each with 6 recurving petals. Z5–9. **‘Anna Marie’** bears spikes of single, pale pink flowers; good for forcing. **‘Blue Jacket’** illus. p.403. **‘Carnegie’** produces compact spikes of single, pure white flowers in late spring. **‘City of Haarlem’** illus. p.407. **‘Delft Blue’** has violet-flushed, soft blue flowers. **‘Distinction’** produces slender, open spikes of reddish-purple flowers. **‘Gipsy Queen’** bears single, salmon-orange flowers; those of **‘Jan Bos’** are crimson. **‘Lady Derby’** bears rose-pink flowers. **‘L’ Innocence’** has ivory-white flowers. **‘Ostara’** produces a large spike of blue flowers, with a dark stripe along each petal center. **‘Pink Pearl’** bears a dense spike of carmine-pink flowers. Flowers of **‘Princess Maria Christina’** are salmon-pink; those of **‘Queen of the Pinks’** are soft pink. **‘Violet Pearl’** produces spikes of violet flowers. **‘White Pearl’** illus. p.415.

HYDRANGEA

HYDRANGEACEAE

Genus of deciduous and evergreen shrubs and climbers, rarely trees, grown for their mainly domed or flattened flower heads. Each head usually consists of many small, inconspicuous, fertile flowers, surrounded by or mixed with much larger, sterile flowers bearing showy, petal-like sepals. However, in some forms, all or most of the flowers are sterile. Prefers full sun or semishade and fertile, moist but well-drained soil. Needs more shade in dry areas. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer. ☉ All parts of hydrangeas may cause mild stomach upset if ingested; contact with the foliage may aggravate

skin allergies. See also feature panel pp.134–135.

H. anomala subsp. *petiolaris*, syn. *H. petiolaris* (Climbing hydrangea), illus. p.195.

H. arborescens ‘Grandiflora’ (illus. p.134). Deciduous, open shrub. H and S 8ft (2.5m). Long-stalked, broadly ovate leaves are glossy, dark green above, paler beneath. Bears large, rounded heads of mainly sterile, white flowers in summer. Z4–9

H. aspera. Deciduous, upright shrub with arching branches. H and S 10ft (3m). Young stems are finely haired. Has lance-shaped to ovate, dark green leaves, downy beneath. Bears broad heads of pale blue, inner flowers, surrounded by lilac-pink to white, outer ones, in summer. Z6–9. **‘Anthony Bullivant’** (Lacecap) has broad, dark blue or plum fertile flowers surrounded by roundish, pink sterile flowers.

‘Macrophylla’ has broad, dark green leaves with margins rolled under and circular, blue-eyed, white, sterile flowers surrounding bright violet-blue, fertile flowers. **‘Mauvette’** (illus. p.135) has slightly deeper purple-mauve flowers. **subsp. sargentiana** (syn. *H. sargentiana*; illus. p.135), H 8ft (2.5m), S 6ft (2m), is gaunt, with peeling bark, sturdy shoots, and very large, ovate, bristly, dull green leaves, downy beneath. Inner flowers are blue or deep purple, the outer ones larger and white, sometimes flushed purplish-pink. **Villosa Group** (syn. *H. villosa*) illus. p.133. **Villosa Group** ‘Velvet and Lace’ (Lacecap) has ovate to lance-shaped leaves, softly hairy beneath. Bears flower heads comprising purple-blue, fertile flowers and nodding, mauve-pink sterile, outer flowers, from midsummer to late fall.

H. heteromalla. Deciduous, arching shrub. H 15ft (5m), S 10ft (3m). Narrowly ovate, dark green leaves turn yellow in fall. Broad, flat, open heads of white flowers, 7in (17cm) across, are borne in mid- and late summer. Z4–9. **Bretschneideri Group** has peeling, chestnut-brown bark and large leaves, to 5in (12cm) long and half as much wide. **‘Snowcap’** (illus. p.134) has large, flat, white flower heads, to 10in (25cm) across.

H. integerrima. See *H. serratifolia*.

H. involucrata. Deciduous, spreading, open shrub. H 3ft (1m), S 6ft (2m). Has broadly heart-shaped, bristly, mid-green leaves. During late summer, bears heads of small, blue, inner flowers surrounded by large, pale blue to white, outer ones. Z7–11. **‘Hortensis’** (illus. p.134) is smaller and has clusters of cream, pink and green flowers. Z7–9

H. macrophylla (Bigleaf hydrangea). Deciduous, bushy shrub. H 5–6ft (1.5–2m), S 6–8ft (2–2.5m). Has ovate, toothed, glossy, light green leaves. In mid- to late summer, blue or purple flowers are produced in acidic soils with a pH of up to about 5.5. In neutral or alkaline soils above this level, flowers are pink or red. White flowers are not affected by pH. Prune older shoots back to base in spring. Trim back winter-damaged shoots to new growth and remove spent flower heads in spring. Cultivars of *H. macrophylla* are divided into 2 groups: Hortensias have domed,

dense heads of mainly sterile flowers; Lacecaps have flat, open heads, each with fertile flowers in the center and larger, sterile flowers on the outside that are green in bud. Z6–9. **‘Altona’** (Hortensia; illus. p.134), H 3ft (1m), S 5ft (1.5m), has large heads of rich pink to deep purple-blue flowers. **‘Blaumeise’** (Teller Series; Lacecap), H 5ft (1.5m), has light blue, fertile flowers with white stamens and large, brilliant-blue, sterile flowers; colors best on acidic soils high in aluminium. **‘Europa’** (Hortensia; illus. p.135), H 5ft (1.5m), S 3ft (1m), produces large florets of rich pink flowers. Flower heads of **‘Générale Vicomtesse de Vibraye’** (Hortensia, H and S 5ft (1.5m), are rounded and pale blue or pink. Foliage is light green. **‘Geoffrey Chadbund’** see *H.m.* **‘Möwe’.** **‘Hanabi’** (Lacecap), is tall-growing, with double, green, fertile flowers surrounded by a ring of long-stalked, double, star-shaped, blue, sterile flowers resembling an exploding firework. **‘Hamburg’** (Hortensia; illus. p.134), is vigorous and has large heads of dark pink to dark blue flowers with toothed sepals. **‘Kardinal’** (Teller Series; Lacecap), is vigorous, with dark red florets in a double ring. **‘Klaveren’** (Lacecap), H 4ft (1.2m), has lilac-pink flowers in large heads, to 8in (20cm) across. **‘Lanarth White’** (Lacecap; illus. p.134), H and S 5ft (1.5m), has pink or blue, fertile flowers edged with pure white, sterile flowers. **‘Libelle’** (Teller Series; Lacecap; illus. p.135), H and S 5ft (1.5m), produces very pale blue flowers, fading to creamy-white, over a long period. **‘Lilacina’** see *H.m.* **‘Mariesii Lilacina’.** **‘Love You Kiss’** (Hovaria Series; Lacecap), H 3ft (1m), is low-growing, with red-flushed leaves and white flowers with deep pink margins. **‘Mariesii Lilacina’** (syn. *H.m.* ‘Lilacina’; Lacecap; illus. p.134), H and S 6ft (2m), has deep lilac, central flowers and pinkish-purple, outer flowers. **‘Möwe’** (Teller Series; syn. *H.m.* ‘Geoffrey Chadbund’; Lacecap), H and S 3ft (1m), has broad, flat flower heads ranging in color from purple-red to deep pink. **‘Nachtigall’** (Teller Series; Lacecap), H 5ft (1.5m), has dark blue or violet (pink on chalky soils), sterile flowers in a single ring around pale-budded, violet-anthered, fertile flowers. **‘Pfau’** (Teller Series; Lacecap), H 2ft (60cm), is dwarfish, bearing small flower heads of bright blue or pink florets with pointed sepals. **‘Preziosa’** see *H.* **‘Preziosa’.** **‘Quadricolor’** (Lacecap), H 5ft (1.5m), S 4ft (1.2m), has leaves boldly variegated in green, cream, and yellow, and pale pink flowers; often confused with the weaker-growing ‘Tricolor’. **‘Rotschwanz’** (Teller Series; Lacecap), H 5ft (1.5m), has large flower heads with star-shaped, deep red, sterile flowers around pink-anthered, pale, fertile flowers. **subsp. serrata** see *H. serrata*. **‘Tokyo Delight’** (Lacecap), H and S 3ft (1m), produces pink or white flowers that mature to wine-red. **‘Tricolor’** (Lacecap), H 6ft (2m), S 5ft (1.5m), has variegated, gray-green and yellow leaves and bears pale pink to white flowers in late summer. **‘Veitchii’** (Lacecap) has lilac-blue, fertile flowers, surrounded by white, sterile flowers that age to pink. **‘Westfalen’** (Hortensia), H and S 3ft (1m), bears bright

red to purple flowers. **‘Zorro’** (Lacecap), H 5ft (1.5m), has sturdy, almost black stems and flower heads of dazzling blue on acidic soils (pink in alkaline conditions). **H. paniculata.** Vigorous, deciduous, spreading to upright shrub. H 6–10ft (2–3m), S 8–10ft (2.5–3m). Has ovate, pointed, toothed, mid- to dark green leaves. In summer and early fall, produces large, usually conical panicles of tiny, sometimes rose-tinted, creamy-white, fertile flowers surrounded by large, petal-like, white, sterile flowers that usually age to varying pink shades. Prune moderately to hard annually to promote vigorous growth and large flower heads. Z4–8. **‘Big Ben’** (illus. p.134), H and S 5½ft (1.7m), has an upright habit, red stems and, in midsummer, produces abundant, large, conical panicles of pale green, sterile florets that turn white and then age to deep pink in midfall. Needs moderate to hard pruning. **‘Brussels Lace’** has dark green leaves and white flowers in late summer and early fall. Needs moderate pruning. **‘Dharuma’** (illus. p.135), H and S 4ft (1.2m), is a compact, relatively slow-growing cultivar with mahogany-red stems, dark green leaves and rounded heads of white, sterile flowers in midsummer; these mature to deep pink by midfall. Best left unpruned or given only light pruning annually. Good in a small garden. **‘Limelight’** (illus. p.135), H 5½ft (1.7m), S 7ft (2.2m), is robust and produces very dense, broadly conical panicles of lime-green, sterile flowers in midsummer, maturing to a mixture of lime-green and warm pink by midfall. Needs moderate pruning. **‘Phantom’** (illus. p.134), H 5ft (1.5m), S 7ft (2.2m), is a robust, upright cultivar producing dense, conical, rounded heads of sterile, white flowers, flushed yellow-green at tips, in midsummer; these age to warm, deep pink by early fall. Needs moderate to hard pruning. Flower heads of **Pink Diamond (‘Interhydia’)** (illus. p.135), turn pink with age. **Pinky-Winky (‘Dvppinky’)** (illus. p.134), H 4½ft (1.4m), S 5½ft (1.6m), has a compact, upright, slightly spreading habit with dark red stems, yellowish-green leaves and dense, tapered, conical heads of lime-green, sterile flowers in midsummer; these age to deep pink by early fall. Responds well to moderate pruning. Good in a small garden. **‘Silver Dollar’** (illus. p.134), H 4ft (1.2m), S 5½ft (1.7m), is compact with strong stems. Bears dense, rounded heads of white, sterile flowers, tipped pale yellow-green, in midsummer; they mature to pink in midfall. Responds well to hard pruning. Good in a small garden. **‘Unique’** is vigorous and produces very large flower heads of mainly sterile, white flowers that age to pinkish-white. **H. petiolaris.** See *H. anomala* subsp. *petiolaris*. **H. ‘Preziosa’**, syn. *H. macrophylla* ‘Preziosa’, *H. serrata* ‘Preziosa’. Deciduous, bushy shrub. H 5–6ft (1.5–2m), S 5ft (1.5m). Has ovate, toothed, light green leaves. Pink flowers turn to deep crimson. Z6–9 **H. quercifolia** (Oakleaf hydrangea). Deciduous, bushy, mound-forming shrub.